DAWN PAPPAS

PROJECT MANAGER | IMPLEMENTATION LEAD | BUSINESS OPERATIONS

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Project Management professional with 13+ years of experience leading enterprise implementations, cross-functional initiatives, and operational programs within a Fortune 100 financial services organization. Proven success managing complex projects from planning through execution by coordinating business stakeholders, technical teams, vendors, and executive leadership while delivering measurable business results.

Combines a unique background in Project Management, Systems Analysis, Enterprise Learning, and Technology to successfully deliver initiatives that improve operational efficiency, strengthen stakeholder engagement, and support organizational change. Recognized for translating complex business requirements into practical solutions, building scalable processes, and driving projects to successful completion through collaboration, organization, and data-driven decision making.

Known for developing strong relationships, bringing structure to ambiguity, and balancing strategic objectives with exceptional attention to detail.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Led enterprise implementation of two leadership development programs supporting senior leadership, coordinating cross-functional teams, vendors, budgets, logistics, and project execution.
- Managed 10–25 concurrent implementation projects while maintaining timelines, stakeholder communication, and successful delivery.
- Directed enterprise Learning Management System initiatives supporting 77,000+ employees, including annual compliance training deployments and enterprise-wide learning operations.
- Served as one of only four administrators authorized to configure complex dynamic learning audiences due to the technical complexity and enterprise-wide impact.
- Developed executive Tableau dashboards providing real-time compliance and operational reporting for HR, Legal, and Employee Relations.
- Built enterprise Confluence knowledge repositories, implementation documentation, technical standards, and operational playbooks that improved knowledge sharing and long-term support.
- Supported Agile software implementation projects by gathering business requirements, managing technical documentation, coordinating testing, and facilitating successful SSO integrations.
- Delivered process improvements that generated approximately $42,000 in annual operational savings while improving operational efficiency and learner experience.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Project Management | Program Management | Cross-Functional Leadership | Stakeholder Management | Agile & Scrum Methodologies | Project Planning | Project Execution | Risk Management | Change Management | Requirements Gathering | Business Analysis | Process Improvement | Vendor Management | Executive Reporting | KPI Development | Resource Planning | SDLC | Enterprise Implementations | Operational Excellence | Continuous Improvement

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Project & Collaboration: Jira | Confluence | Microsoft Project | ServiceNow | SharePoint

Learning & Business Systems: SumTotal LMS | Workday | SAP | Concur

Reporting & Analytics: Tableau | Microsoft Excel | Power BI (Foundational)

Communication & Productivity: Microsoft Office Suite (Excel, Word, PowerPoint, Outlook) | Microsoft Teams | Zoom | WebEx

Technical: HTML | CSS | Business Process Documentation | Technical Documentation | Knowledge Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Fidelity Investments

Oct 2011 – Sep 2024

Implementation Lead *(Feb 2022 – Sep 2024)*

Led enterprise learning and business initiatives by managing project execution, stakeholder engagement, vendor relationships, budgets, reporting, and cross-functional collaboration supporting leadership development and enterprise compliance programs.

- Directed end-to-end implementation of two enterprise leadership development programs, coordinating stakeholders, vendors, budgets, schedules, and logistics while ensuring successful project delivery.
- Managed project plans, timelines, milestones, resource allocation, risks, dependencies, and deliverables across multiple concurrent initiatives.
- Facilitated project meetings, communicated project status to leadership, and provided ongoing reporting on milestones, risks, issues, and project outcomes.
- Led Agile project tracking through Jira, improving project transparency, prioritization, collaboration, and execution across cross-functional teams.
- Oversaw vendor selection, contract management, procurement coordination, and annual program budgets while maintaining strong external partnerships.
- Administered the enterprise SumTotal Learning Management System, supporting learning initiatives for more than 77,000 employees through enterprise system configuration, compliance training deployment, and operational support.
- Served as one of only four enterprise LMS administrators authorized to configure and maintain complex dynamic learning audiences due to the technical complexity and enterprise-wide impact of learner assignments.
- Led annual compliance training deployments by partnering with HR, Legal, and Employee Relations to ensure accurate audience targeting and regulatory compliance.
- Designed customized HTML/CSS training communications that improved learner engagement and standardized enterprise-wide training notifications.
- Developed executive Tableau dashboards that transformed enterprise learning data into real-time reporting for compliance tracking, completion metrics, and leadership decision-making.
- Established Confluence documentation standards, knowledge repositories, and operational playbooks to improve project consistency, documentation quality, and long-term support.
- Leveraged project metrics, stakeholder feedback, and operational data to identify opportunities for continuous improvement, contributing to approximately $42,000 in annual operational savings.

Systems Analyst *(Mar 2020 – Feb 2022)*

Partnered with business stakeholders, product owners, engineers, quality assurance teams, and external financial institutions to support enterprise Single Sign-On (SSO) integration projects. Managed requirements gathering, technical documentation, Agile delivery support, and post-implementation activities while ensuring secure, reliable system integrations.

- Partnered with internal stakeholders and external financial institutions to gather business requirements, define project scope, and translate operational needs into technical solutions supporting enterprise SSO implementations.
- Collaborated with Project Managers, Product Owners, Software Engineers, Quality Assurance teams, and third-party vendors throughout the Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC) to deliver secure, high-quality integrations.
- Supported Agile delivery by participating in sprint planning, backlog refinement, requirements clarification, release planning, and production implementation activities.
- Coordinated testing efforts, implementation schedules, production deployments, and post-production support to ensure successful project execution and operational readiness.
- Identified project risks, system dependencies, and implementation challenges, proactively partnering with technical teams to develop mitigation strategies and minimize operational impact.
- Developed and maintained enterprise tracking solutions for SSL certificates, providing proactive visibility into certificate expirations and reducing operational risk across numerous external integrations.
- Leveraged technical knowledge and programming experience to create comprehensive Confluence knowledge repositories containing implementation documentation, system architecture diagrams, coding references, troubleshooting guides, operational procedures, and best practices.
- Authored standardized implementation guides that translated complex security requirements into structured documentation, enabling engineers and analysts to efficiently support and maintain enterprise SSO connections.
- Coordinated ongoing vendor communications, certificate renewals, production maintenance, and security enhancements to maintain reliable enterprise integrations.
- Maintained project documentation, implementation records, technical specifications, and knowledge repositories to support long-term operational sustainability and continuous improvement.

- Recognized as a trusted technical resource for documenting complex integrations and developing reusable implementation standards that improved consistency across project teams.

Implementation Specialist *(Mar 2016 – Mar 2020)*

Managed multiple concurrent enterprise learning implementation projects supporting large-scale business initiatives. Coordinated project planning, stakeholder communications, logistics, system administration, vendor management, and operational execution to ensure successful program delivery and exceptional customer experiences.

- Managed 10–25 concurrent implementation projects, balancing competing priorities while consistently delivering projects on schedule and meeting stakeholder expectations.
- Partnered with business leaders, facilitators, subject matter experts, vendors, and operational teams to coordinate project plans, implementation schedules, resource allocation, and successful program execution.
- Administered the SumTotal Learning Management System (LMS) for Workplace Investments, configuring learning assignments, instructor-led training, virtual learning, compliance requirements, certifications, curricula, and learner records.
- Configured complex dynamic learning audiences using HR organizational data to ensure accurate training assignments by business unit, location, reporting structure, and job role.
- Served as one of the organization's primary experts in dynamic audience configuration, leveraging technical expertise to develop highly complex audience logic while minimizing enterprise risk.
- Processed Learning Needs Requests (LNRs), maintained LMS configuration, tested course deployments, validated learner assignments, and ensured production readiness prior to enterprise-wide launches.
- Designed customized HTML and CSS email notifications within SumTotal, creating engaging learner communications tailored to specific business units and improving the overall learner experience.
- Extracted enterprise learning data from SumTotal and developed Tableau dashboards and Excel reporting that provided leadership with actionable insights into learner participation, compliance, utilization, and program effectiveness.
- Coordinated large-scale virtual and instructor-led training programs by managing facilitator schedules, participant communications, training calendars, room assignments, technical readiness, and implementation logistics.
- Managed travel arrangements, hotel accommodations, conference facilities, catering, and Concur expense reporting for enterprise training events supporting facilitators, leadership, and large participant groups.
- Conducted comprehensive pre-launch readiness reviews, facilitator rehearsals, and technical validation sessions to ensure seamless program execution and exceptional learner experiences.
- Identified opportunities to streamline implementation processes, standardize documentation, and improve operational efficiency across enterprise learning initiatives.
- Collaborated closely with HR, Learning & Development, IT, Compliance, Legal, Procurement, and business leadership to successfully implement enterprise learning programs supporting organizational goals.

Annuity Case Manager *(Jan 2014 – Mar 2016)*

Managed high-value financial transactions and operational workflows while ensuring regulatory compliance, data accuracy, and exceptional customer service. Partnered with internal business units, external vendors, and financial professionals to resolve complex issues and support successful client outcomes.

- Reviewed and processed annuity applications, ensuring accuracy, completeness, and compliance with regulatory and company requirements.
- Managed high-value financial transactions ranging from $25,000 to multi-million-dollar annuity transfers, consistently maintaining 100% accuracy.
- Collaborated with internal business partners, customers, financial advisors, and external vendors to resolve complex Not In Good Order (NIGO) cases and facilitate timely processing.
- Researched operational issues, identified root causes, and coordinated resolution efforts across multiple departments.
- Maintained detailed documentation while ensuring adherence to regulatory guidelines, operational procedures, and service-level expectations.
- Prioritized competing work assignments in a fast-paced production environment while consistently meeting quality, productivity, and turnaround goals.
- Built trusted relationships with internal and external stakeholders through responsive communication and proactive issue resolution.

401(k) Customer Service Representative *(Oct 2011 – Jan 2014)*

- Delivered exceptional customer service and retirement plan support to participants across multiple employer-sponsored retirement plans while consistently exceeding performance expectations for quality, efficiency, and customer satisfaction.
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- Assisted participants with retirement account inquiries, benefits, distributions, investment options, and plan administration.
- Managed high-volume inbound call queues while navigating multiple enterprise systems to research accounts and resolve complex customer inquiries.
- Consistently exceeded performance metrics for quality, productivity, customer satisfaction, and Average Handle Time.
- Maintained quality scores of 90% or higher while consistently achieving 95% or better Average Handle Time performance.
- Demonstrated exceptional empathy, professionalism, and problem-solving skills while assisting customers through complex financial situations.
- Documented customer interactions accurately and ensured timely follow-up for issues requiring additional research or cross-functional support.
- Recognized as a trusted resource for retirement plan operations, policy interpretation, and customer service excellence.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Everest University

Master of Business Administration, Human Resources Management — Summa Cum Laude
Bachelor of Science, Computer Information Science — Summa Cum Laude

Certified Associate in Project Management (CAPM)
Certified Scrum Master (CSM)

PROFESSIONAL STRENGTHS

- Builds collaborative relationships across technical and business organizations.
- Thrives in fast-paced, highly regulated enterprise environments.
- Communicates effectively with executives, stakeholders, vendors, and cross-functional teams.
- Combines technical aptitude with strong business acumen to solve complex operational challenges.
- Recognized for organization, follow-through, adaptability, and continuous process improvement.
- Passionate about mentoring others, improving workflows, and delivering exceptional customer experiences.